

Disaster Preparedness & Response Planning

Learner guide | SWP-025 | School of Disaster Response & Crisis Intervention

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Disaster Preparedness & Response Planning. By the end of the course, you should be able to support organisational and community readiness before and during a disaster.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Support organisational and community readiness before and during a disaster.
- Apply the key ideas from Disaster-risk context.
- Apply the key ideas from Preparedness planning.
- Apply the key ideas from Response coordination.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Disaster-risk context	hazards, vulnerability, capacity, inclusion, and ethical preparedness	10 to 15 minutes
2. Preparedness planning	roles, communications, evacuation/shelter supports, safeguarding, and continuity plans	10 to 15 minutes
3. Response coordination	rapid needs assessment, information management, referrals, staff safety, and review	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Disaster-risk context

This module focuses on hazards, vulnerability, capacity, inclusion, and ethical preparedness. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Hazards
- Vulnerability
- Capacity
- Inclusion
- Ethical preparedness

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of disaster-risk context in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of hazards, vulnerability, capacity, inclusion, and ethical preparedness. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through disaster-risk context safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Preparedness planning

This module focuses on roles, communications, evacuation/shelter supports, safeguarding, and continuity plans. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Roles
- Communications
- Evacuation/shelter supports
- Safeguarding
- Continuity plans

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of preparedness planning in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of roles, communications, evacuation/shelter supports, safeguarding, and continuity plans. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through preparedness planning safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Response coordination

This module focuses on rapid needs assessment, information management, referrals, staff safety, and review. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Rapid needs assessment
- Information management
- Referrals
- Staff safety
- Review

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of response coordination in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of rapid needs assessment, information management, referrals, staff safety, and review. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through response coordination safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: risk.
- Review the distinction between: preparedness roles.
- Review the distinction between: coordination.
- Review the distinction between: inclusion.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.